

Dr. Alejandro Bernales

Ph.D. in Finance

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English: Fluent Spanish: Native French: Intermediate

Short Bio and Professional Activities

Alejandro Bernales is a consultant, advisor, researcher, and academic with over 20 years of international experience in financial economics. He is an Associate Professor (with tenure) at the School of Economics and Business, Universidad de Chile, where he also serves as Director of the Doctoral (Ph.D.) Program at the Business School and previously served as Director of Research and Director of the Master in Finance program.

Dr. Bernales has held positions as a Research Fellow at the Inter-American Development Bank, a Marie Curie Fellow at the European Commission, and an economist at both the Banque de France (the central bank of France) and the Central Bank of Chile. He has served on the Scientific Committee for Economics and Business at Chile's National Agency for Research and Development (ANID), within the Ministry of Science. He has also held visiting and teaching positions at various international institutions, including the University of Sydney, Goethe University Frankfurt, and ESSEC Business School in Paris.

He has extensive experience as a director in the financial sector and has provided consultancy services to a wide range of institutions, such as companies, law firms, international organizations, and governments. His expertise encompasses regulation, impact evaluation, legal cases involving the financial sector, corporate events, investments, valuations, and portfolio strategies.

Dr. Bernales has published numerous articles in international scientific journals specializing in financial economics and finance. He regularly contributes opinion columns to newspapers and online media. He is fluent in Spanish and English, with intermediate proficiency in French.

Dr. Bernales earned his Ph.D. in Finance from the University of Manchester, United Kingdom, and holds a Master's degree in Financial Engineering (Highest Honors, *summa cum laude*) and a Bachelor's degree in Industrial Engineering (Highest Honors, *summa cum laude*) from the Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile.

Positions

2020–Present **Associate Professor (with tenure)**, *School of Economics and Business, Universidad de Chile, Santiago, Chile*

2014–2020 **Assistant Professor**, *School of Economics and Business, Universidad de Chile, Santiago, Chile*

2017 **Visiting Professor**, *University of Sydney, Sydney, Australia*

2016 **Visiting Professor**, *Goethe University Frankfurt, Frankfurt, Germany*

2015 **Visiting Professor**, *Instituto Universitário de Lisboa, Lisbon, Portugal*

- 2014–2015 **Research Fellow**, *International Finance and Banking Society (IFABS)*, UK
- 2011–2014 **Research Economist**, *Banque de France*, Paris, France
- 2013–2014 **Adjunct Professor of Finance**, *Universidad de Chile*, Santiago, Chile
- 2012–2013 **Adjunct Professor of Finance**, *ESSEC Business School*, Paris, France
- 2011–2012 **Adjunct Professor of Finance**, *Université Catholique de Lille*, Lille, France
- 2007–2011 **Marie Curie Fellow**, *European Commission*, Belgium
- 2007 **Researcher**, *Central Bank of Chile*, Santiago, Chile
- 2005–2007 **Research Fellow**, *Inter-American Development Bank (IDB)*, Washington, DC, USA
- 2004–2005 **Researcher**, *Lab. for Financial Research*, *Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile*, Santiago, Chile

Consultancy

- 2005–Present **Consultant**
Consultancy work for a variety of institutions, including private sector companies, international organizations, and governments, in areas such as regulation, legal cases involving the financial sector, corporate events, investment decisions, valuation, and portfolio strategies.
- 2017–2019 **Board Member**, *CUANTSERV - Stratagemma Trading Systems*
- 2017–2018 **Research Advisor**, *CUANTSERV - Stratagemma Trading Systems*

Academic Service

- 2026–Present **Director of the Ph.D. Program at the Business School**, *School of Economics and Business, Universidad de Chile*
- 2022–Present **Recruitment Committee**, *School of Economics and Business, Universidad de Chile*
- 2024–2026 **Director of Research**, *School of Economics and Business, Universidad de Chile*
- 2023–2026 **Tenure-Track Committee for Young Faculty**, *School of Economics and Business, Universidad de Chile*
- 2020–2026 **Director of the Master in Finance**, *School of Economics and Business, Universidad de Chile*
Led the process through which the program achieved CFA Institute University Affiliation Program (UAP) status.
- 2022–2025 **Central Electoral Commission (university governance body)**, *Universidad de Chile*
- 2023 **Scientific Committee (Economics and Business Research Area)**, *National Agency for Research and Development (ANID), Ministry of Science, Government of Chile*
- 2019–2020 **Advisory Board Member**, *Undergraduate Program, Universidad de Chile*
- 2018–2020 **Advisory Board Member**, *Ph.D. Program, Universidad de Chile*

Research Areas

Financial economics and finance, including both empirical and theoretical studies, as well as other fields involving financial or investment decisions.

Publications and Working Papers (with Revise-and-Resubmit and Reject-and-Resubmit) in WoS Journals

1. Decomposing Informed Trading in Equity Options, 2026 (with F. Asencio, D. González, R. Holowczak, and T. Verousis), **Journal of Econometrics**.
 - *Best Publication of the Year Award, School of Economics and Business, Universidad de Chile (2026)*.
2. Aggregate Risk and Lending Decisions in the Interbank Market, 2026 (with A. Bechara, C. Cañón, and N. Garrido), **Journal of Money, Credit and Banking**.
3. Informational Economic Transmission between Countries, 2025 (with H. Karnani and P. Margaretic), **Review of Economic Dynamics**.
4. Execution Risk and Price Improvement under Dark Pools, 2025 (with D. Ladley, E. Litos, and M. Valenzuela), **Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control**.
5. The Nonlinear Dynamics of Relative Collateralized-Uncollateralized Funding Activity, 2025 (with A. Bechara, C. Cañón, and N. Garrido), Conditionally Accepted at **Journal of Empirical Finance**.
6. International Spillover Effects of Economic Policy Uncertainty, 2025 (with D. Cumming, P. Margaretic, and R. Muñoz), Revise and Resubmit at **Journal of International Business Studies**.
7. Monetary Policy Spillovers and Wholesale Funding Shocks in Global Bank Subsidiaries, 2025 (with A. Bechara and C. Cañón), Revise and Resubmit at **Journal of International Money and Finance**.
8. Learning in the Dark: Size-Based Execution Priority in Dark Pools under Reinforcement Learning, 2025 (with D. Ladley, E. Litos, and M. Valenzuela), Revise and Resubmit at **Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control**.
9. Option Listings, Stock Price Informativeness and Investment Decisions, 2025 (with L. Chen, L. Reus, T. Verousis, and J. Azócar), Revise and Resubmit at **International Review of Economics and Finance**.
10. Trader Competition in Fragmented Markets: Liquidity Supply Versus Picking-Off Risk, 2024 (with N. Garrido, S. Sagade, M. Valenzuela, and C. Westheide), **Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis** (forthcoming).
 - *Best Paper Award, Asian Finance Association (2017)*.
11. Speculative Bubbles under Supply Constraints, Background Risk and Investment Fraud in the Art Market, 2022 (with L. Reus and V. Valdenegro), **Journal of Corporate Finance** 77, Article 101746.
12. The Effect of Environmental Policies on Risk Reductions in Energy Generation, 2021 (with G. Acevedo, A. Flores, R. Moreno, and A. Inzunza), **Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control** 126, Article 104027.
13. Learning and Index Option Returns, 2020 (with G. Cortazar and G. Skiadopoulos), **Journal of Business and Economic Statistics** 38(2), 327–339.

14. Blue-Collar Crime and Finance, 2022 (with D. Beuermann, D. Cumming, and C. Olid), **Journal of International Financial Markets, Institutions and Money**.
15. Do Investors Follow the Herd in Option Markets?, 2020 (with T. Verousis and N. Voukelatos), **Journal of Banking and Finance** 119, Article 104899.
 ○ *Nominated for Best Conference Paper at the FMA (2015).*
16. What Do We Know About Individual Equity Options?, 2020 (with T. Verousis, N. Voukelatos, and M. Zhang), **Journal of Futures Markets** 40, 67–91.
17. Make-Take Decisions under High-Frequency Trading Competition, 2019, **Journal of Financial Markets** 45, 1–18.
 ○ *Lead article in the Journal of Financial Markets (2019).*
 ○ *Nominated for Best Conference Paper at the EFMA (2013).*
18. Bid-Ask Spread and Liquidity Searching Behaviour of Informed Investors in Option Markets, 2018 (with T. Verousis and C. Cañón), **Finance Research Letters** 25, 96–106.
19. Learning and Forecasts about Option Returns through the Volatility Risk Premium, 2017 (with L. Chen and M. Valenzuela), **Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control** 82, 312–330.
 ○ *Nominated for Best Conference Paper at the EFMA (2014).*
20. The Success of Option Listings, 2017, **Journal of Empirical Finance** 40, 139–167.
21. CVaR-Constrained Planning of Renewable Generation with Consideration of System Inertial Response, Reserve Services and Demand Participation, 2016, **Energy Economics** 59, 104–117.
22. Learning to Smile: Can Rational Learning Explain the Predictable Dynamics in the Implied Volatility Surface?, 2015 (with M. Guidolin), **Journal of Financial Markets** 26, 1–37.
 ○ *Nominated for Best Conference Paper at the FMA (2012).*
23. Thinly Traded Securities and Risk Management, 2014 (with G. Cortazar and D. Beuermann), **Estudios de Economía** 41, 5–48.
24. Can We Forecast the Implied Volatility Surface Dynamics for CBOE Equity Options?, 2014 (with M. Guidolin), **Journal of Banking and Finance** 46, 326–342.

Working Papers

1. A Nearby Wake-Up Call for Price Reaction Dynamics, 2026 (with N. Berardi and L. Reus), submitted.
2. Learning from News, Information Flow, and Financial Markets, 2025 (with M. Valenzuela and I. Zer), close to submission.
 ○ *Best Paper Award, Financial Engineering and Banking Society (2024).*
3. Effects of Information Overload on Financial Market Returns: How Much Is Too Much?, 2025 (with M. Valenzuela and I. Zer), submitted.
 ○ *Nominated for Best Conference Paper at the EFMA (2025).*
4. Wisdom of the Crowd or Just Noise? Correlation Neglect under Peer Effects, 2025 (with R. Barriá, J. Peters, Marcela Valenzuela, Miguel Valenzuela, and I. Zer), submitted.
5. Option-Implied Correlation and Market Returns, 2024 (with M. Valenzuela), close to submission.

Work in Progress

1. Understanding Collateral Chains (with P. Margaretic and C. Cañón).
2. The Diffusion of Option Adoption (with T. Verousis and D. Díaz).
3. Dynamics in Multi-Markets: Quality and Financial Technological Changes (with M. Valenzuela and O. Lebedeva).

Book Chapter

- The Effects of Derivatives on Underlying Financial Markets, in *50 Years of Money and Finance: Lessons and Challenges*, 2013, edited by Morten Balling and Ernest Gnan, published by Larcier and SUEF Studies.

Conferences and Seminars

- 2026 INFORMS (*Management Science*) Conference on Financial Engineering and Fintech (New York); China International Conference in Finance (CICF-JFQA, Hong Kong); Central Bank of Chile; International Conference of the Association Française de Finance (AFFI, France); University of Talca.
- 2025 European Financial Management Association Conference (EFMA, Greece); Universidad de Chile (Business School).
- 2024 Society for Financial Econometrics Conference (SoFiE, Brazil); Financial Engineering and Banking Society Conference (FEBS, Paris).
- 2023 News and Finance Conference (Columbia University); Future of Financial Information Conference (JFQA, HEC Paris); Universidad de Chile (Department of Economics); IFABS Conference (University of Oxford); Banque de France.
- 2022 International Conference on Macroeconomic Analysis and International Finance.
- 2020 Annual Meeting of the Central Bank Research Association (CEBRA).
- 2019 PUC-Rio; University of Birmingham; Banco de México; FGV; Universidad de los Andes; Banque de France; 4th International Workshop in Financial Econometrics (Brazil).
- 2018 Society for Financial Studies (SFS) Finance Cavalcade; Financial Management Association Conference.
- 2017 FIRS Conference; New York University; ITAM; PUC Chile; Banco de México; 3rd International Workshop in Financial Econometrics.
- 2016 Bocconi University; Goethe University Frankfurt; University of Piraeus.
- 2015 Federal Reserve Board; University of Colorado; Bank of England; University of York; University of Leicester; Central Bank of Brazil.
- 2014 New York University; City University of Hong Kong; Université Paris Dauphine; Universidade Católica Portuguesa; University of Bath; IFABS Conference; Universidad Adolfo Ibáñez; Banque de France.

- 2013 Toulouse School of Economics; Collège de France; CFTC; Schulich School of Business; IHS (Vienna); 9th ECB Workshop on Microstructure; EEA (Gothenburg); 3rd CFS/Deutsche Börse IOSDM; FMA (Chicago); UCL Algo and HFT; 30th FFA; 5th NYSE Euronext Hedge Fund Conference; Pontificia Universidad Javeriana; Rouen Business School; Universidad de Chile; Banque de France.
- 2012 Financial Management Association (FMA, Atlanta); French Economic Association; Central Bank of Chile; IFABS Conference (Valencia); FEBS Conference (London).
- 2011 Federal Reserve Board (Research Department); Erasmus University Rotterdam; Banque de France; University of Leicester; Monash University; University of Melbourne; University of Manchester; IESEG; University of Liverpool; Lancaster University.
- 2010 30th International Symposium on Forecasting (San Diego); EFMA (Aarhus); 8th INFINITI (Dublin); Safety and Risk in Complex Systems Symposium (Saint Petersburg, Russia).
- 2009 American Finance Association (AFA, San Francisco, USA).
- 2008 European Financial Management Association (EFMA, Athens); International Federation of Operational Research Societies Conference (South Africa).
- 2007 Financial Management Association (FMA, Orlando, USA); Midwest Finance Association (Chicago, USA); Global Finance Conference (Rio de Janeiro); Washington Area Finance Association (Washington, DC, USA).

Grants, Honors, and Scholarships

- 2026 Best Publication of the Year Award, School of Economics and Business, Universidad de Chile (for “Decomposing Informed Trading in Equity Options,” *Journal of Econometrics*, 2026).
- 2025 Fondecyt Regular, Chilean Government research grant #1251636 (Co-Researcher, approx. US\$155,000, 4 years).
- 2024 Fondecyt Regular, Chilean Government research grant #1240312 (Co-Researcher, approx. US\$150,000, 4 years).
- 2024 Best Paper Award, Financial Engineering and Banking Society.
- 2023 Fondecyt Regular, Chilean Government research grant #1231660 (Principal Investigator, approx. US\$165,000, 4 years).
- 2023 Fondecyt Regular, Chilean Government research grant #1231630 (Co-Researcher, approx. US\$160,000, 4 years).
- 2023 Research grant #R156, School of Economics and Business, Universidad de Chile (Principal Investigator, approx. US\$8,000, 1 year).
- 2019 Fondecyt Regular, Chilean Government research grant #1190162 (Principal Investigator, approx. US\$140,000, 4 years).

- 2019 Fondecyt Regular, Chilean Government research grant #1190477 (Co-Researcher, approx. US\$143,000, 4 years).
- 2018 ENLACE grant #ENL13/18 (Principal Investigator, approx. US\$12,000, 1 year).
- 2017 Best Paper Award, Asian Finance Association.
- 2015 Millennium Science Initiative grant, Millennium Institute (approx. US\$2,500,000, 5 years).
- 2014 Fondecyt Iniciación, Chilean Government research grant #11140628 (Principal Investigator, approx. US\$135,000, 3 years).
- 2014 IFABS Fellowship grant.
- 2014 Visiting Scholar grant, Banque de France.
- 2011 Marie Curie Fellowship grant, European Commission (4 years).
- 2010 Invitation and travel grant, International Institute of Forecasters, 30th International Symposium on Forecasting (San Diego, USA).
- 2009 Invitation and travel grant, American Finance Association (AFA) Annual Meeting (San Francisco, USA).
- 2008 Invitation and travel grant (young researcher), Nobel Laureate Meeting (Lindau, Germany).
- 2007 Manchester Business School Doctoral Studentship, University of Manchester.
- 2004 Residence Scholarship, Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile.
- 2003 Parallel Degree Scholarship, Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile.
- 1997 Runner-up, Chilean National Knowledge Olympiad (Physics).

Policy Reports

- Algorithmic and High-Frequency Trading: A Brief Synthesis, 2014, Research Department, Banque de France.
- Changes in the Correlation and Effects of Segmentation in the European Banking Sector, 2013, Research Department, Banque de France.
- Measurement of Systemic Risk, 2012, Research Department, Banque de France.
- Lessons from the Swedish Crisis in the Early 1990s for the 2012 Spanish Storm in the Banking Sector, 2012, Research Department, Banque de France.
- European Bond Proposals: A Comparison, 2012, Research Department, Banque de France.
- Analysis of Alternative Efficient Indexation in Relation to Cap-Weighted Indices, 2011, Research Department, Banque de France.
- Performance Evaluation of the Implementation of Term-Structure Interest Rate Models Using Bonds Issued by the Central Bank of Chile, 2009, Central Bank of Chile.
- Country Program Evaluation: Uruguay, 2005, Inter-American Development Bank (IDB).
- Annual Performance Evaluation of Development Projects in Region 2 (Central America, Mexico, and the Caribbean), 2005, Inter-American Development Bank (IDB).
- Annual Performance Evaluation of Development Projects in Region 2 (Central America, Mexico, and the Caribbean), 2006, Inter-American Development Bank (IDB).

- Country Program Evaluation: Costa Rica, 2006, Inter-American Development Bank (IDB).
- Country Strategy: Costa Rica, 2006, Inter-American Development Bank (IDB).

Teaching

- 2026 Asset Pricing (Undergraduate), Option Pricing and Strategies (Postgraduate).
- 2025 Asset Pricing (Undergraduate), Option Pricing and Strategies (Postgraduate).
- 2024 Asset Pricing (Undergraduate), Option Pricing and Strategies (Postgraduate).
- 2023 Asset Pricing (Undergraduate), Option Pricing and Strategies (Postgraduate), Advanced Asset Pricing (Postgraduate).
- 2022 Asset Pricing (Undergraduate), Option Pricing and Strategies (Postgraduate).
- 2021 Asset Pricing (Undergraduate), Option Pricing and Strategies (Postgraduate), Advanced Asset Pricing (Postgraduate).
- 2020 Asset Pricing (Undergraduate), Option Pricing and Strategies (Postgraduate).
- 2019 Asset Pricing (Undergraduate), Option Pricing and Strategies (Postgraduate), Advanced Asset Pricing (Postgraduate).
- 2018 Asset Pricing (Undergraduate), Option Pricing and Strategies (Postgraduate).
- 2017 Asset Pricing (Undergraduate), Option Pricing and Strategies (Postgraduate).
- 2016 Asset Pricing (Undergraduate), Option Pricing and Strategies (Postgraduate).
- 2015 Asset Pricing (Undergraduate), Option Pricing and Strategies (Postgraduate).
- 2014 Asset Pricing (Undergraduate), Option Pricing and Strategies (Postgraduate).
- 2013 International Finance (Postgraduate).
- 2012 International Finance (Postgraduate), Fundamentals of Futures Markets (Postgraduate).
- 2011 Option Pricing and Strategies (Postgraduate).

Postgraduate Students

- Karnani, Hriday, 2025, Informational Linkages and Stock Market Comovement.
- Prieto Álvarez, Joaquín, 2023, Conexión informacional entre mercados financieros internacionales.
- Zúñiga Olave, Diego, 2023, Informational Links in Financial Markets (Definición y estimación del canal informacional en el mercado accionario).
- Muñoz Álvarez, Rodrigo, 2022, Efectos directos y spillovers de incertidumbre política económica sobre inversión en activos fijos.
- Acevedo Echeverría, Giancarlo Andrés, 2022, Planificación óptima: un estudio sobre flexibilidad.
- Uribe Pizarro, Pablo Nicolás, 2022, Price Changes and Competition between French Retailers.
- Peters Mosler, Javier Andrés, 2021, Do Peer AFPs Affect Asset Allocation Decisions?
- Valenzuela Herbosa, Miguel Ignacio, 2021, Market Frictions in Investment Decisions due to Peer Effects.
- González Maldonado, Daniel Iván, 2021, Riesgo de información asimétrica en el mercado de

opciones.

- Welch Soto, Javier Ignacio, 2020, Introducción de opciones: estudio de sus retornos y del efecto en la sensibilidad inversión-Q.
- Azócar Romero, Javiera Alejandra, 2020, Variables que influyen en el proceso de adopción de nuevas opciones.
- Asencio Barría, Felipe Esteban, 2020, Market Friction under Asymmetric Information in the Option Market.
- Valdenegro Cabrera, Víctor Eduardo, 2018, Speculation and Hedging in Art Markets.
- Bórquez O., Diego, 2019, Volatilidad accionaria y spreads de bonos corporativos bajo distintos niveles de endeudamiento y caja.
- Olid R., Christian, 2019, Blue-Collar Crime and Finance.
- Matus F., Sebastián, 2019, Creando un nuevo índice bilateral de integración política: efectos en los flujos de capitales.
- Concha V., Pedro, 2018, Arbitraje en mercados financieros fragmentados.
- Garrido S., Nicolás, 2017, Dynamic Equilibrium in Multiple Limit Order Markets: Overlapping.
- Astargo Q., Sebastián, 2017, Estudio del proceso de adopción de nuevas opciones financieras y sus retornos.
- Oteiza A., Francisco, 2017, Integración y condiciones económicas globales: efectos en el crecimiento.
- Vargas V., Maricel, 2017, News in Dynamic Markets.
- Sepúlveda S., Diego, 2017, Rollover Risk, Cash Holdings and Credit Spreads: An Empirical Analysis.
- Orellana A., Rodrigo, 2016, Dynamic Equilibrium in Multiple Limit Order Markets: Analysis of Depth Disclosure and Lit Fragmentation.
- Brito G., Fernando, 2016, Fertility and Household Savings: The Case of Chile.
- Rugiero D., Nora, 2015, Efectos del subsidio a la forestación: evidencia al cambio en el Decreto Ley N° 701.

Other Academic Responsibilities

Refereeing	Journal of Finance, Journal of Econometrics, Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control, Review of Finance, European Journal of Operational Research, Journal of Corporate Finance, Energy Economics, Journal of Empirical Finance, Finance Research Letters, Journal of Banking and Finance, Quantitative Finance, International Journal of Forecasting, among others.
Editorial Duties	Guest Editor, <i>Economic Modelling</i> , special issue on Challenges to Financial Stability in Latin America (2027); Guest Editor, <i>Journal of Corporate Finance</i> , special issue on Corporate Finance Decisions in a Changing Global Environment (2018).
Professional Memberships	American Finance Association; American Economic Association; European Economic Association; European Finance Association; Financial Management Association.
Conference Organizer	Santiago Finance Workshop (2015–2026); IFABS-LA 2018; Chile-Brazil Finance Conference 2020; among others.

Computing Skills and Financial Database Knowledge

- Computing Skills Python, Java, Visual Basic, C, C++, Fortran, MATLAB, GAUSS, SAS, R, SQL Server, EViews, SPSS, Amos, Maple, AMPL, LaTeX.
- Databases TAQ, Bloomberg, OptionMetrics, Compustat, CRSP, I/B/E/S, among other financial databases.

Extracurricular Activities

- 2010–2014 Member of the Board of the Association of Chilean Students and Alumni UK/Ireland (£5,000 raised through different activities in the UK and Ireland).
- 2005–2010 Member of the Chilean American Foundation (CAF), which supports small social-impact projects in Chile.
- 1998–2004 Voluntary social work in low-income communities in southern Chile.

Graduate Studies

- 2007–2011 **Ph.D. in Finance**, Manchester Business School, University of Manchester, UK. Thesis: *Essays on Option Markets: Empirical and Theoretical Learning Models*.
- 2003–2005 **Master of Science in Financial Engineering**, Highest Honors (*summa cum laude*), Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile, Santiago, Chile.

Undergraduate Studies

- 1998–2003 **Industrial Engineering**, Highest Honors (*summa cum laude*), Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile, Santiago, Chile.
- 1998–2003 **Major in Mechanical Engineering**, Highest Honors (*summa cum laude*), parallel degree (completed in 2005), Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile, Santiago, Chile.

References

References available upon request.